

Mgr. Andy Cohen Also Says Stadnicki Has New Denver Offer

By BILL KEATING

LAKE WALES, Fla. — Called one of the serious contenders for a regular job with the Denver club of the American Assn. is Frank Leja of Holyoke.

Andy Cohen, former major leaguer who is the Denver club manager, called Leja:

"One of our most serious contenders for first base."

Denver is playing exhibition games with other minor league clubs in the area and in the first game lost to Charleston of the International League, 5-0. Denver collected seven hits and Frank had two of those seven.

"He looks very good at first," continued Cohen, "tho there are two other candidates for the job. If he hits Frank has a good chance of winning the assignment."

Leja was one of the group whom Mgr. Casey Stengel ordered to St. Pete last month for pre-season instruction after the Holyoke lad had experienced a tremendous season with Binghamton, Eastern League champion in 1957.

Asked about pitcher Johnny this writing, had not reported to the Denver club, Cohen said:

"Well, he hasn't reported as far as I know. He had a fine record (23-6) on the Western League with Topeka last year. What makes that record more impressive is that the parks in that league are small and there are a lot of good hitters."

Cohen said a very good offer was made to Johnny by the Denver management but was not at liberty to divulge the amount.

Some weeks back it was learned that Stadnicki was dissatisfied with the terms offered and said he would not report. He is a student at Westfield Teachers College. Salary figures mentioned at that time did not jibe with figures (off the record) mentioned here.

Johnny was Milwaukee Braves property and had been on the draft list last winter with the N.Y. Yankees grabbing him.

The Braves were loaded with right hand pitchers and are concentrating on southpaws to back up Warren Spahn, veteran lefty who is starting his 14th season with the world champions. Spahn will be 37 next month.

Cohen concluded:

"We haven't received any word here from Stadnicki and there hasn't been any indication of when he will report or whether he plans to report."

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